EXPERIMENT 14

Pro-Code Extension of a Zoho Creator Application

Project: Job Application Management System

Aim

To explore how the Job Application Management System built in Zoho Creator can be extended using Deluge custom functions, REST APIs, widgets, and external serverless functions for recruitment-related processing.

Introduction

Zoho Creator supports the main application workflow through forms, reports, dashboards, and Deluge scripts. Some advanced recruitment requirements—such as complex candidate scoring, resume text extraction, bulk application processing, or integration with external job portals—may require logic beyond the standard low-code workflow. A hybrid design can keep the user interface in Creator while using external functions for specialized processing when needed.

Extension Options for the Job Application Project

Extension	Project-specific use
Deluge custom functions	Reuse salary validation, normalize job-role values, prepare application summaries, or send a notification after a submission.
Client-side widgets	Add a custom recruiter view showing application status, role-wise counts, or candidate summary information where the account supports widgets.
Creator REST APIs	Allow an authorized external recruitment portal or internal HR tool to read or update application records using scoped OAuth permissions.
Zoho Catalyst / external functions	Run heavier tasks such as resume text processing, candidate-score calculation, or batch processing outside the main Creator workflow.

Suggested Integration Flow

Recruiter or administrator → Job Application form in Zoho Creator → Deluge custom function or authenticated API request → external function processes selected application data → structured JSON response → Creator displays the result or updates an authorized record.

Implementation Procedure

1. Identify one recruitment task that is difficult to maintain entirely in a basic form workflow, such as calculating a transparent candidate score from configured criteria.

2. Define the input fields needed for the task, for example Job Role, Experience, Skills, and a non-sensitive application identifier.

3. If using Deluge, create a small reusable function and call it from the relevant workflow or button.

4. If using an external service, create and test a function endpoint, then document its URL and expected JSON input/output.

5. Configure an authorized connection using the supported authentication method. Do not hard-code tokens or secrets in scripts.

6. Call the function from Creator, validate the response, and handle timeout, authorization, and invalid-input errors.

7. Test with sample applications and compare the returned values with manually checked results.

8. Restrict access to the function and log failures without exposing resumes, contact details, or other unnecessary personal data.

Example Use Cases

• **Candidate score:** calculate a transparent score from configured job-related criteria, with recruiter review before decisions.

• **Resume processing:** extract text from uploaded resumes through an approved service if available, then let a recruiter verify the extracted information.

• **Bulk reporting:** process application summaries for role-wise reports without repeatedly performing expensive work in each form submission.

• **External integration:** share selected application details with an authorized HR system through a secured API.

Security and Best Practices

1. Keep each function focused on one task and validate all incoming data.
2. Use JSON with clearly defined field names for data exchange.
3. Store credentials in approved connections or secure configuration rather than directly in code.
4. Apply least-privilege access and restrict who can invoke endpoints.
5. Handle failures with clear messages and suitable retry logic where safe.
6. Document versions and test changes before using them with live candidate records.
7. Treat automated scoring as decision support, not as the sole basis for hiring decisions.

Conclusion

The Job Application Management System can use Zoho Creator for forms, workflows, reports, and dashboards while reserving advanced processing for Deluge custom functions or external services when required. This hybrid approach can improve flexibility, but external integrations must be authenticated, tested, and checked against account and connection limits before they are described as implemented.